17 For larger pieces such as bowl blanks you could put the resin directly into the body of the chamber, but for these pen blanks I used a plastic container to hold the resin, thus reducing the amount needed and making cleaning up less of a chore. You only need sufficient resin to cover the blanks; too much and it may overflow from the container under vacuum

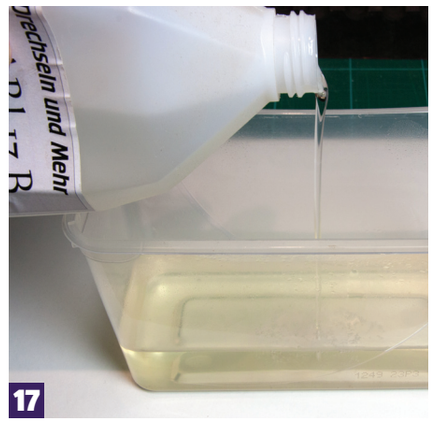
18 Make sure to use a container that is resistant to the chemicals you are using. The blanks will need to be weighted down to stop them from floating. I used an offcut of steel angle that I had in the scrap bin

19 The container is then placed into the chamber, the lid is replaced and we are ready to apply the vacuum

20 With both valves on the vacuum chamber closed, the airline and vacuum pipes are connected to the vacuum generator and the generator is turned on

21 The inlet valve can now be gradually opened to allow the vacuum to evacuate any air from the timber and replace it with resin. This should be done by adjusting the inlet valve gradually until full vacuum is achieved. You will see air bubbles coming from the blanks, I have opened the valve fully in the photograph so the bubbles can be seen more clearly, but gradually increasing the vacuum will avoid excessive foaming

22 Once the maximum vacuum has been achieved the inlet valve may be closed and the blanks left in the vacuum for the time specified by the manufacturer of the resin you are using. The vacuum generator can be turned off but left connected in case the vacuum needs to be topped up. After the specified time the vacuum is released by opening the outlet valve, the wood can then be removed and treated in accordance with the instructions for your stabilising product ●



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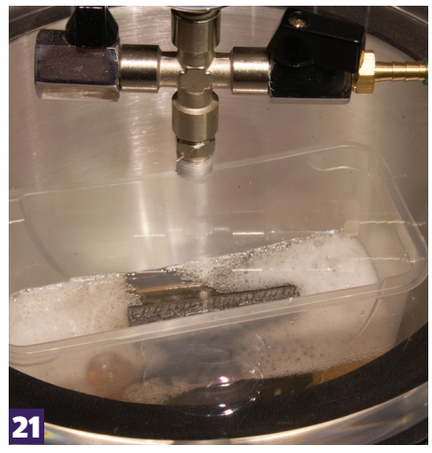
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The stabilised blanks now need to dry fully before use, but already they are much harder and less fragile

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